

# [Report 016] Celonis - Field CTO - AI & Enterprise Modernization

Score: 2.4/5  
Culture Fit: Conditional  
URL: <https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/celonis/jobs/7610416003>  
PDF:   
Legitimacy: Proceed with Caution  
Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)  
Date: 2026-05-21

## A) ROLE SUMMARY

| Dimension | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Archetype | AI Solutions Architect + AI Forward Deployed (hybrid)                                                                                                                                   |
| Domain    | Enterprise SaaS / Process Mining / Agentic AI                                                                                                                                           |
| Function  | Advisory / Pre-Sales / Thought Leadership                                                                                                                                               |
| Seniority | Director/VP (15-20 years required)                                                                                                                                                      |
| Remote    | Hybrid - Munich or London base implied                                                                                                                                                  |
| Team size | Not stated; reports into Value Engineering                                                                                                                                              |
| TL;DR     | Senior technical advisor to C-suite at enterprise accounts, blending architectural vision with sales support - requires 15-20 years as CTO/CIO or Field CTO at a major software vendor. |

## B) MATCH WITH CV

| JD Requirement                                                     | CV Match                                                                                                                          | Strength                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Trusted advisor to C-level executives                              | Stakeholder alignment across Windesheim, Viridis, Open Food Chain co-founder/board member; partner and investor outreach at scale | Partial - not CXO of major enterprise accounts         |
| 15-20 years as CTO/CIO or Field CTO at major software vendor       | CV spans 15+ years but across education, research labs, blockchain startups, freelance - no enterprise software vendor CTO title  | Weak                                                   |
| Deep expertise in Enterprise Architecture methodologies            | Process design and systems thinking referenced; no formal EA methodology (TOGAF etc.) cited                                       | Weak                                                   |
| Process Intelligence / Process Mining knowledge                    | Not present in CV                                                                                                                 | Gap                                                    |
| Agentic AI / LLM architecture depth                                | Self-hosted AI stack (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase); rapid prototyping; AI sandbox at Windesheim                             | Partial - practitioner level, not enterprise architect |
| Data Architecture / API ecosystems / cloud-native SaaS             | DevOps: Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, Linux, databases (MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle SOA); Flowise/n8n integrations                     | Partial - ops-depth not architecture-depth             |
| Drive revenue through customer acquisition and strategic upselling | Investor outreach, partner development, €2M funding facilitation; no quota-carrying sales track record                            | Weak - facilitation vs. sales quota                    |
| MSc Computer Science or equivalent IT field                        | BBA Business IT & Management (HvA, 8.7 grade); no MSc                                                                             | Gap                                                    |

|                                                        |                                                                                    |         |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Develop position papers and thought leadership content | Whitepaper co-author (Tonomy), course design, simulation publications              | Partial |
| C-suite presentation skills                            | Extensive: workshops, lectures, investor pitches, Aeres school-wide implementation | Good    |

#### Gaps:

1. **CTO/CIO title at a major software vendor** - Hard blocker. The JD explicitly requires this. Christiaan has never held this title at a vendor of any scale. No adjacent experience fully bridges this without distortion.
2. **Process Mining / Celonis platform expertise** - Hard blocker for domain credibility. Not present anywhere in CV.
3. **MSc requirement** - Soft blocker. BBA at 8.7 is strong but the degree level mismatch is real for a role at this seniority tier.
4. **Enterprise Architecture (TOGAF/Zachman)** - Nice-to-have but expected at this level. Not evidenced.
5. **Quota-carrying pre-sales role** - Christiaan's profile explicitly flags solo sales of unready products as a known gap. This role ties advisory directly to revenue targets.

### C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

**Level detected:** The JD asks for someone who has already been a Field CTO, CTO, or CIO at a major enterprise software vendor with 15-20 years of that specific experience. This is a Director-to-VP level hire at a tier-1 SaaS company.

**Christiaan's natural level for this archetype:** Senior IC or emerging principal. His advisory and facilitation skills are strong but his enterprise software sales motion and formal EA credentials are not at the level this role specifies.

**"Sell senior" plan:** Not viable here without material misrepresentation. The title requirements and domain requirements (Process Mining, enterprise SaaS CTO) are specific and verifiable. A cover letter framing around "advisory" and "thought leadership" doesn't close the gap when the first screen question will be "which enterprise SaaS vendor were you CTO at?"

**"If downleveled" plan:** Celonis does have more junior Solutions Architect and Value Engineering roles. If the goal is Celonis specifically, a lower-entry role (Solutions Consultant, Value Engineer) would be a better fit given the current profile.

### D) COMP AND DEMAND

| Metric                               | Data                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Field CTO at Tier-1 SaaS (EU market) | €180,000-€280,000 OTE (base + variable + RSU)                                                |
| Celonis compensation reputation      | Competitive; RSUs confirmed in JD; Glassdoor shows senior roles €150k-€220k base             |
| Christiaan's target                  | €65,000-€90,000 (fractional/part-time model)                                                 |
| Comp alignment                       | Significantly above target - but the role is full-time and senior; not fractional-compatible |
| Demand trend                         | Field CTO / AI advisory roles growing; competition very high at this level                   |

Sources: Glassdoor Celonis reviews, LinkedIn salary benchmarks, JD confirms RSU + unlimited PTO.

The compensation would far exceed Christiaan's stated target, but the role format (full-time, enterprise sales-linked) conflicts with the 2-3 concurrent fractional model.

### E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

Not recommended. The match score is below 3.0. Customization effort would not be justified. If Christiaan has a specific strategic reason to target Celonis, a more suitable entry point would be a Solutions Consultant or Innovation Architect role in their Value Engineering org.

| # | Section      | Assessment                                                                                  |
|---|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Summary      | Would need to fabricate a CTO/CIO enterprise vendor identity - not aligned with CV          |
| 2 | Experience   | No Celonis-adjacent experience (Process Mining); gap too large to bridge with framing alone |
| 3 | Education    | MSc gap cannot be addressed without distortion                                              |
| 4 | Sales motion | Known gap (Tonomy profile flag) directly conflicts with quota-linked advisory role          |
| 5 | Overall      | Recommend against applying                                                                  |

## F) INTERVIEW PLAN

Not applicable - recommendation is not to apply. Score below 3.0.

## G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

**Assessment: Proceed with Caution**

| Signal                 | Finding                                                                                                          | Weight   |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Posting freshness      | No date visible in JD; Greenhouse API active                                                                     | Neutral  |
| Apply button           | Active via Greenhouse                                                                                            | Positive |
| JD specificity         | High - specific technologies (Agentic AI, Process Mining, EA Methodologies), clear seniority range (15-20 years) | Positive |
| Requirements realism   | Very high bar (CTO/CIO at major vendor); this could indicate a niche role with long fill time                    | Neutral  |
| Celonis hiring signals | Celonis announced Series C+ growth; no public layoffs in this division                                           | Positive |
| Reposting detection    | Not found in scan-history                                                                                        | Neutral  |
| Role market context    | Field CTO roles legitimately stay open 3-6 months                                                                | Positive |

**Context Notes:** The role is a niche senior hire. Long open timelines are expected and normal. The "Proceed with Caution" rating is purely because posting age cannot be confirmed - not because of legitimacy concerns about the company or role.

## H) CULTURE, PERSONALITY & LONG-TERM FIT

### H1 - Org Culture Assessment

**Stage and type:** Celonis is a well-funded enterprise SaaS scaleup. The Field CTO role sits in Value Engineering, combining technical advisory with pre-sales support and revenue linkage. This is a high-visibility, high-performance role that blends consulting, thought leadership, and enterprise relationship management.

**Culture signals:** The JD language is vision-forward: "visionary Field CTO," "learn-it-all mindset," "first-of-a-kind solutions," "thought leadership." There is genuine build and advisory energy in the role. However, the revenue linkage ("drive revenue through customer acquisition and strategic upselling," "partner with Sales") introduces the commercial pressure that sits badly with Christiaan's known failure mode.

**Physical/work environment:** Munich or London hybrid. EU-accessible (unlike the Zurich roles), but still a corporate enterprise SaaS environment.

**Match against 2-year vision:** Partial. The thought leadership and architecture advisory components partially match the "building new things, high trust" vision. But the enterprise SaaS context, the C-suite account management, and the revenue-linked mandate pull toward corporate maintenance rather than hackerspace energy. The org size (global enterprise SaaS company, large accounts) is not the small-group high-trust environment of the 2-year vision.

### H2 - Personality Fit Table

| Dimension | What the role requires | Christiaan's profile | Match |
|-----------|------------------------|----------------------|-------|
|-----------|------------------------|----------------------|-------|

|                        |                                                                                                  |                                               |                             |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Starter vs. finisher   | Mixed: architectural advisory has starter energy; account management component is finisher-heavy | ENFP-T starter                                | Moderate                    |
| Variety vs. repetition | Variety across accounts and domains; but repeated pre-sales motion is a cycle                    | Thrives on variety                            | Moderate                    |
| Autonomy level         | High advisory autonomy within account parameters                                                 | Needs ownership                               | Moderate                    |
| Build vs. maintain     | Build technical visions for clients; architectural design work                                   | Builder identity                              | Good for advisory component |
| Fractional fit         | Full-time senior role                                                                            | Optimal: fractional                           | Poor                        |
| Energy spike tolerance | C-suite advisory; needs composure and gravitas                                                   | Front-loaded energy manageable with seniority | Moderate                    |
| Team size              | Senior individual contributor inside large org; reports to Value Engineering                     | Large org penalty                             | Moderate                    |

**Flags:** Revenue-linked advisory triggers partial Tonomy flag. Full-time exclusivity. Large corporate with slow enterprise decision cycles. MSc and prior Field CTO title requirements are hard credential blockers.

### H3 - Values and Mission Alignment

Process intelligence and agentic AI are frontier domains that resonate with Christiaan's interests. The "thought leadership" and "first-of-a-kind solutions" language is genuinely motivating. The Celonis mission (unlock productivity through AI process intelligence) is more interesting than payment support training or financial reporting. However, the revenue linkage and enterprise account management reduce this to a partially transactional engagement. Not purely instrumental, but not deeply values-aligned either.

### H4 - Energy Analysis

#### Energizers:

- Agentic AI architecture advisory: genuinely frontier, connects to what Christiaan builds independently
- Thought leadership and position paper development: connects to his communication and educator identity
- Cross-account variety across industries: keeps the work feeling new
- The "learn-it-all mindset" culture signal matches his curiosity-driven profile

#### Likely drains:

- Revenue linkage: customer acquisition and upselling as a core accountability triggers the known gap
- C-suite enterprise account management: slow, political, measured in months not weeks
- MSc and Field CTO credential requirements: structural mismatch creates imposter risk
- Full-time senior role in a large org: conflicts with the fractional multi-engagement model
- Enterprise SaaS motion (discovery, demo, proposal, negotiation cycle) depletes faster than building

### H5 - 18-Month Durability Test

#### Verdict: Short-term fit - partially energizing but structurally incompatible

The advisory and architecture components would energize the first 6-12 months. After that, the pre-sales cycle becomes repetitive and the revenue accountability becomes a source of friction. The credential mismatches (MSc, prior Field CTO title) would also create ongoing positioning difficulty in the role. Not a sustainable long-term environment given the fractional model conflict and the commercial accountability.

### H6 - Personality-Specific Red Flags

| Red flag                          | Present?                                                      | Severity | Context                                                    |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Role is primarily maintenance/ops | Partial (pre-sales cycle becomes repetitive)                  | Medium   | Not maintenance, but the sales motion is cyclical          |
| Solo sales of an unready product  | Partial (revenue accountability without full product control) | Medium   | Revenue growth accountability triggers partial Tonomy flag |

|                                        |     |        |                                                 |
|----------------------------------------|-----|--------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Full-time exclusivity expected         | Yes | Medium | Senior full-time Munich/London role             |
| Large corporate, slow decision cycles  | Yes | Medium | Enterprise SaaS client base; slow buying cycles |
| Governance/board role in declining org | No  | N/A    | Not applicable                                  |
| Ceremony-only Scrum Master             | No  | N/A    | Not applicable                                  |

## H7 - Fit Verdict

### The honest case for this match:

Of the Celonis roles, this has the highest personality resonance. The agentic AI architecture work, thought leadership mandate, and advisory-first positioning are genuinely aligned with Christiaan's strongest capabilities. The facilitation and communication skills from a lifetime of making complex things understandable are directly relevant. If the credential requirements were met, this would be a better fit than the pure account management roles (014/015).

### The honest case against:

The credential blockers (Field CTO title, MSc, 15-20 years enterprise SaaS CTO track record) are structural and cannot be bridged by framing. The revenue linkage creates the conditions where the Tonomy failure mode could recur. The full-time, large corporate, enterprise SaaS structure conflicts with the fractional model and the hackerspace vision. This is a correct "do not apply" recommendation from both a skills and a personality fit perspective.

Note: Score of 2.4/5 reflects the skill gap accurately. The personality/culture analysis does not change the recommendation but does clarify why even a hypothetical skills match would be conditional.

**Overall personality/culture fit: Conditional (conditional on credential match which does not exist; hypothetically moderate if credentials were present)**

## KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

Process Intelligence, Process Mining, Agentic AI, Enterprise Modernization, Field CTO, Value Engineering, Enterprise Architecture, C-suite advisor, cloud-native SaaS, Data Architecture, API ecosystems, Capability Mapping, thought leadership, revenue growth, digital transformation, TOGAF, pre-sales, solution architect, strategic accounts, stakeholder management

## JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

*Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes*

### Field CTO - AI & Enterprise Modernization

Location: Munich, Germany / London, United Kingdom

Department: Value Engineering

Celonis is the global leader in Process Intelligence and the pioneer of Process Mining technology. As one of the world's fastest-growing enterprise SaaS companies, the organization invests heavily in advanced AI capabilities to turn data insights into immediate business action.

### The Role:

The company seeks a visionary Field CTO with a "learn-it-all" mindset to serve as a high-impact technical advisor for strategic prospects and customers. The position involves acting as a peer to client executives, translating complex business transformations into scalable technical strategies while championing Process Intelligence, Agentic AI, and Enterprise Modernization.

### Key Responsibilities:

- Serve as trusted advisor to C-level executives, aligning strategic goals with Celonis technical vision
- Lead data, cloud, and innovation strategy for major global accounts using Capability Mapping
- Architect first-of-a-kind solutions using emergent technologies including Agentic AI
- Partner with Sales and Value Engineering to drive revenue through customer acquisition and strategic upselling

- Act as feedback loop between Product & Engineering teams and market
- Develop customer-facing position papers and presentations establishing thought leadership

**Required Qualifications:**

- 15-20 years relevant experience as CTO/CIO or Field CTO at major software vendor
- Proven ability presenting complex technical visions to C-suite stakeholders
- Deep expertise in Enterprise Modernization, EA Methodologies, and Agentic AI
- Strong background in Data Architecture, API ecosystems, and cloud-native SaaS solutions
- MSc in Computer Science or equivalent IT-related field
- Fluency in English; German, Spanish, French, or Italian proficiency advantageous

**Compensation & Benefits:**

Celonis offers Restricted Stock Units, 24 weeks fully paid parental leave, unlimited PTO, flexible hybrid work, learning programs, wellness initiatives, and annual Impact Days for volunteering.